

Arunabha Majumder

Research Engineer — Wearable Robotics, Exoskeletons, Actuators & Experimental Validation

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Project: www.viexo.aau.dk

SUMMARY

Researcher in wearable robotics and exoskeletons with hands-on experience across the full mechatronic chain: actuator and transmission design (compliant and soft pneumatic actuators), CAD and FEM, 3D-printed prototypes, sensor integration, motion and force control in MATLAB/Python, and experimental validation with human participants. Best Paper Award, IFToMM ISRM 2026.

KEY RESULTS

- **>25%** energy reduction with a hybrid-actuated shoulder exoskeleton
- **>15%** lower user muscle effort with Assist-as-Needed control
- **<10%** RMS force-estimation error for physical human-robot interaction

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Engineer / PhD Researcher – Wearable Robotics & Exoskeletons (VIE XO Project) | 2023 – Present

Aalborg University, Department of Materials and Production, Aalborg, Denmark

- Reduced energy consumption by more than 25% (Best Paper Award, IFToMM ISRM 2026) by designing a hybrid-actuated shoulder exoskeleton that combines a compliant parallel spring with a 6 Nm motor in a new actuator and transmission concept.
- Developed functional robot prototypes from concept to experimental validation through iterative design in SolidWorks and Fusion 360, FEM of load-carrying parts, 3D printing, machining and hands-on assembly.
- Reduced user muscle effort by more than 15%, measured with EMG, by integrating and controlling the motor, encoder and force sensors with an Assist-as-Needed controller for physical human-robot interaction.
- Achieved below 10% RMS force-estimation error, validated against a force sensor, by developing a force-sensing method for a 5-bar planar parallel robot using variable-stiffness actuators and the robot Jacobian; applied it to measure human arm impedance in the gait lab.
- Collected a full experimental dataset, using EMG and motion capture, by conducting experiments with 12 participants across 3 assistance modes and 2 load conditions.
- Supervised Bachelor's (B.Tech) students and taught university courses (2023 – 2025); disseminated results at international conferences.

MTech Researcher – Soft Pneumatic Actuators (Master's Thesis) | 2020 – 2022

CSIR-Central Mechanical Engineering Research Institute (CMERI), National Laboratory, Durgapur, India

- Reduced position-tracking error to 0.3–0.78%, outperforming classical PID, by developing a neural-network-based gain-scheduled controller in MATLAB/Simulink for a non-linear soft pneumatic artificial muscle.
- Characterised soft actuator behaviour experimentally by fabricating pneumatic artificial muscles from raw materials and building a test rig with valves, pressure sensors and DAQ; published at IEEE CONECCT 2022.

Bachelor's Capstone – Upper-Limb Rehabilitation Exoskeleton | 2018 – 2019

Siddaganga Institute of Technology, Tumakuru, India

- Led CAD design, fabrication and user testing of a rehabilitation exoskeleton; Best Major Project Award and INR 100,000 TATA Technologies Innovation Grant.

PUBLICATIONS

- Majumder, A., Wagner, J.W., Zhu, Y., Oliveira, A.S., and Bai, S. "A Hybrid Actuated Shoulder Exoskeleton for Energy-Efficient Upper Arm Support." *Robotics and Mechatronics: ISRM 2026, MMS*, vol. 213, Springer, 2026. Best Research Paper Award.
- Majumder, A., Sarkar, D., Chakraborty, S., Singh, A., Roy, S.S., and Arora, A. "Neural Network-Based Gain Scheduled Position Control of a Pneumatic Artificial Muscle." *IEEE CONECCT*, 2022.

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Candidate, Mechatronics & Robotics | 2023 – Present

Aalborg University, Department of Materials and Production, Aalborg, Denmark

M.Tech (Master's), Mechatronics | 2020 – 2022

AcSIR – CSIR-Central Mechanical Engineering Research Institute (CMERI), Durgapur, India

B.Tech, Mechanical Engineering | 2015 – 2019

Siddaganga Institute of Technology, Visvesvaraya Technological University (VTU), Tumakuru, India

SKILLS

- **Design & prototyping:** SolidWorks (CSWA), Fusion 360, FEM/FEA, 3D printing, machining, assembly
- **Programming:** MATLAB/Simulink, Python, LabVIEW (basic), Arduino
- **Control:** Motion and force control, Assist-as-Needed control, PID, neural-network gain scheduling, kinematics
- **Sensors & actuators:** Motors, encoders, force/torque sensors, pressure sensors, DAQ, EMG, Qualisys motion capture
- **Languages:** English (C1, fluent), Bengali (Native), Hindi (Conversational)

AWARDS

- Best Research Paper Award, 9th IFToMM International Symposium on Robotics and Mechatronics (2026)
- Certified SolidWorks Associate (CSWA); TATA Technologies Innovation Grant – INR 100,000 (2019); Best Major Project Award (2019)

REFERENCES

Available upon request.